

Outlook

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Failure reason is not root cause - 2023 control review

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Operations is grouping all failed payments together even though the next action depends on the actual cause. The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure. Different teams have produced different answers from the same period, so population and timing rules need to be visible.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if third-party or bank timeout explains the event?
2. What evidence would instead support that mandate status or retry sequencing explains the event?
3. How do we rule out that insufficient funds explains the event?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use October 2023 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards the operational owner, customer message and monitoring rule for each failure family. A useful output would be a Power BI page with drill-through to a reproducible case list.

Use transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations; ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. One caution: Do not infer a technical component failure beyond the error and timing fields available.

Regards